

Marketing and Market Research

International Business Projects

WIRTSCHAFTS UNIVERSITÄT WIEN VIENNA UNIVERSITY OF ECONOMICS AND BUSINESS

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SYLLABUS WT 2026/27

Module Convenor – Dr Arne Floh



Personal Information

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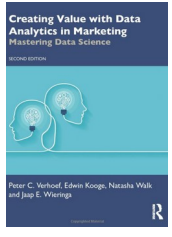
Contact Information

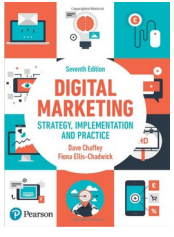
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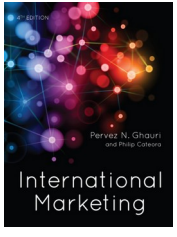
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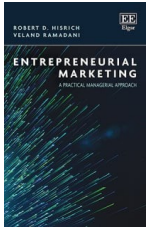


- Work Experience
  - International & Industry Background
  - Teaching Experience > 25 Years
- Teaching
  - International Marketing
  - International Business Projects
  - Marketing Research and Marketing Analytics
  - Global Branding
  - Supervision (BSc, MSc, PhD)
- Research
  - Dynamic Capabilties and Firm Performance
  - GenAI and Marketing
  - SMEs and Internationalization
- Private
  - Football
  - Electronic Gadgets
  - Austrian Wine

























Course synopsis

- Capstone-style course for students specializing in International Business
- Core task: develop a comprehensive international marketing plan
- Marketing and marketing research at the core: investigate markets systematically and evaluate opportunities and risks
- Emphasis on critical thinking, project management and teamwork in a multicultural context
- Outcome: a structured international marketing plan with evidence-based strategic recommendations

Learning objectives

Research & analysis

- Conduct and interpret marketing research for evidence-based decisions
- Analyze competition, customer needs and cultural influences

Strategy & planning

- Design and present a structured international marketing plan based on systematic analysis and research
- Apply marketing concepts internationally and evaluate opportunities and risks across markets
- Develop creativity and problem-solving to propose innovative, feasible strategies

Teamwork & communication

- Strengthen teamwork, project management and intercultural collaboration
- Communicate complex ideas clearly and persuasively, in writing and orally

Teaching and learning: flipped classroom

Before class



- Independent research on key concepts and methods
- Preparation for the next session’s task
- Self-directed learning

In class



- Discussion and application
- Coaching sessions and progress reports
- Peer feedback
- Theory directly connected to the project task

The Julius Meinl case

Marketing plan for entering Latin America

Our partner: Julius Meinl

1862 family-owned Viennese coffee roaster, now in its fifth generation

70+ countries: mostly through local distribution partners

2 segments per market: hospitality and grocery retail

Positioning: Viennese coffee house culture rather than the bean itself, meaning service, hospitality and the idea of taking time for a cup of coffee



How Julius Meinl sells: two segments, two partners

Hospitality (HoReCa)

- Cafés, restaurants and hotels
- The primary segment: hotels matter most, with breakfast and bar business
- A dedicated partner, because hotels and grocery chains are different businesses

Grocery retail

- Coffee for the home, through grocery chains and delicatessen
- Premium assortment
- A dedicated partner: with no own sales organisation in export markets, the partner is the sales force

Who Julius Meinl sells to

Hospitality	Hotels with breakfast and bar service, especially with international guests; premium restaurants and cafés; venues where coffee is part of a quality experience
Retail	Grocery and delicatessen with a premium assortment; shoppers who can pay a premium price; places where brands such as illy are already on the shelf
Less relevant	Venues and retailers competing on price, and areas without purchasing power

The question: growth in Latin America

Julius Meinl sees Latin America (South America and Mexico) as a potential future growth region, where it is currently not present or only marginally.



1. Which Latin American markets are attractive?
2. How could market entry look?
3. How should the brand be marketed?

Central question: Many Latin American countries grow and roast their own coffee and have a strong coffee culture. Why would cafés, hotels, retailers and consumers choose a coffee brand from Vienna, and who exactly would do so?

Six markets, one set of criteria

Markets compared by all groups



Simplified outlines, not to scale

Common criteria by PESTEL dimension

- Political: stability, EU trade agreement
- Economic: purchasing power, consumption, tariff
- Social: coffee culture, tourism
- Technological: digital reach, logistics
- Environmental: demand for certified coffee
- Legal: regulation, product and labelling rules

Assessment strategy

Three group presentations, self-reflection and peer review

Overview of the presentations

Presentation	Length	Weight	Focus
1 Content, 12 Oct	15 min	20 %	Market selection tools: theory, real-world applications, pitfalls
2 Midterm, 16 Nov	20 min	30 %	Country scoring and industry analysis
3 Final, 7 Dec	25 min	30 %	Marketing implementation plan

Presentation 1: market selection tools

1 Content
15 min · 20 %

2 Midterm
20 min · 30 %

3 Final
25 min · 30 %

- Review the tools companies use to screen, compare and select international markets
- Cover the theory, real-world applications and typical pitfalls (e.g., data availability, subjective weighting, outdated indicators)
- Recommend the tool best suited to compare the six Latin American markets for Julius Meinl
- Format: max. 15 minutes and 15 slides, information-rich with clear visualizations
- Document all sources in a separate Excel sheet

Presentation 2: midterm

1 Content
15 min · 20 %

2 Midterm
20 min · 30 %

3 Final
25 min · 30 %

Part A: Scoring method

- One common model: PESTEL criteria and fixed weights for all groups
- Collect and document the data of your allocated country
- Rank of your country among the six, scores by dimension
- Test robustness with the alternative weight sets provided
- Submit one Excel file and one presentation file (20 slides plus appendix); end with a justified recommendation

Part B: Industry analysis

- Statistics from the allocated country
- Hotels and restaurants
- Cafes
- Private end customers
- Value chain, rules of the game
- Trends and online scan of prices

Presentation 3: marketing implementation plan

1 Content
15 min · 20 %

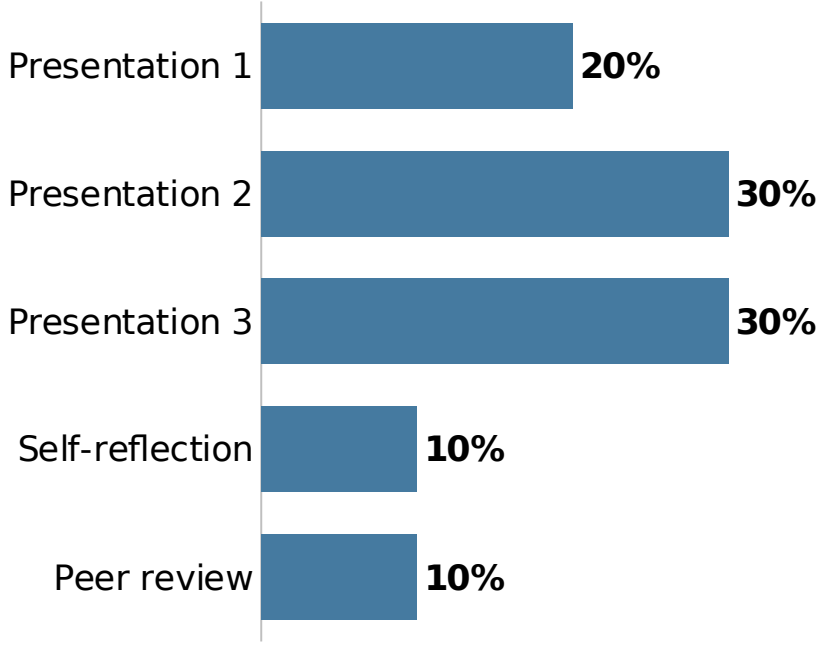
2 Midterm
20 min · 30 %

3 Final
25 min · 30 %

- Market entry and marketing plan for the assigned market: how the brand is marketed and how Julius Meinl enters the market
  - Target segment and first customers
  - Positioning, incl. the answer to the central question
  - Price positioning vs. competition
  - Distribution via a local partner, incl. a profile of a suitable partner
  - Communication and in-market activation (incl. creative implementation)
  - Rough timeline, first-year KPIs and key risks
- Format: max. 25 minutes

Grading

Grade components



Grading scale

- 1 (90–100 %)
- 2 (80–89 %)
- 3 (70–79 %)
- 4 (51–69 %)
- 5 (0–50 %)

Teaching schedule

S1 · 5 Oct

Course content and logistics

→ Prepare content presentation

S2 · 12 Oct

Content presentation

→ **Find 45 criteria**

S3 · 19 Oct

Zoom coaching, 20 min per group

→ **Collect data**

S4 · 9 Nov

Zoom coaching, 20 min per group

→ **Prepare midterm presentation**

S5 · 16 Nov

Midterm presentation

→ **Marketing plan**

S6 · 23 Nov

Coaching session, progress report

→ Refinement and revision

S7 · 30 Nov

Coaching session, progress report

→ Prepare final presentation

S8 · 7 Dec

Final presentation

→ Self-reflection, peer review

Data sources and framework conditions

Framework conditions

- The project is based on publicly available data
- Julius Meinl provides no internal figures (revenues, margins, prices, partner names); none are needed
- When contacting companies or individuals, act as students on a university project, not on behalf of Julius Meinl

Possible sources

- USDA coffee country reports
- Coffee import trade statistics
- National tourism statistics
- Public Julius Meinl material (corporate story, sustainability report, website)

AI, self-reflection and peer review

Use of AI

- Use of (Generative) AI tools is explicitly encouraged
- Tell a rich story in your presentations
- Be honest: list all tools you used
- Graded on quality, innovativeness and variety of sources

Self-reflection and peer review

- Self-reflection: one page on what you learned, what you liked and what can be improved
- Peer review: rate the engagement and performance of your group mates (not yourself); kept confidential
- Submit via Canvas until one week after the last session (14 Dec)

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